



HEDEBY

GERMANY



SICILY

ITALY

POST CARD

Aci Castello today.

A Norman Castle in Sicily! It's crazy to think how far they travelled!

Being a good tourist, I enjoyed a gelato while walking around the ruins. Little did I know, that is a great way to attract wildlife. A raven followed me the whole time!

Half convinced it was you, checking up on me.

Love,
Aunt Liv



TO

John Ericson

24 Longship Way

Ottawa ON K1L 1S1

Canada

FUN FACT

Aci Castello's rock is over 500,000 years old — lava that cooled underwater into a mass of glassy basalt pillars. The castle itself later spent three centuries as a prison, until an 1818 earthquake made it too unsafe to hold anyone.

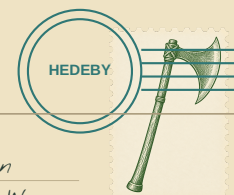
Image adaptation: "Acicastello - Castello Normanno" - Pannuccis, CC BY-SA 4.0.

POST CARD

Today: Hedeby — barely a Hedeby left to stand in, just a green ring of earthwork's where the ramparts ran. From here I'm turning south: nothing but Mediterranean weather for the rest of this trip.

A woodcarver at the reconstruction huts showed me how the old branch-runes worked — count the branches one way for the family, the other way for the letter. I copied his Key out for you before I forgot it.

Love,
Aunt Liv



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FUN FACT

In 1050, during his war with Denmark, Harald burned Hedeby to the ground — sailing burning ships straight into the harbour. Archaeologists later found their charred timbers still lying in the Schlei.

his Key, copied out:

1 - f u þ o r k

2 - h n i a s

3 - t b m l r'

(left branches = which row. right = where in it.)

Image adaptation: "Hedeby, Busdorf (P1100664)" - Matti Blume, CC BY-SA 4.0.